

News Home Reader

Version unspecified

Contents

Status	2
Supported Platforms	3
About	4
Features	5
Installation	6
Downloads	6
Build Yourself	6
Directories	6
Windows Binary	6
Windows zip file	6
Android apk	6
Preliminaries for building on your machine	6
Scoop	7
License	8
What this means for you	8



Status

Version 1.0.0-SNAPSHOT

Supported Platforms

- Android
- Windows
- Linux

About

News Home Reader is a simple yet powerful newsreader which supports feeds of type atom, rdf and rss and runs on android and desktop (currently windows and linux).

For those interested: This is implemented using the latest Kotlin Multiplatform framework.

It can cache full articles along with their images while you are at home for offline use while you are not at home. News can be updated in intervals of 15, 30, 45 and 60 minutes.

There is also an offline catalog on board which was produced from <https://www.rss-verzeichnis.de> which you can use to find some interesting newsfeeds in German.

Currently, the app is not published on any appstore so if you wish to put it on your device or use it on your Windows desktop. Sorry I have no Apple devices, so I cannot test this nor support this platform. Please have a look into the installation section below how to build the app yourself.



The project is currently in early beta. So there might be still bugs and flaws...

Features

News Home Reader is a privacy first newsreader which means that new items and articles are stored only on your device. Synchronization of read news items is only performed within your Wi-Fi zone at home. For now only WebDAV is supported to store the synchronization file, which is just a simple JSON file.

- Reading from Atom, RDF and RSS feeds
- Privacy first approach - nothing is stored outside your device except for syncfiles which may be stored on a WebDAV server of your choice.
- Custom keyword buckets. You can add a dedicated group which is named with a search phrase. When selecting this group you see only news items containing this keyword. Making this the perfect tool if you want to monitor a certain topic across newsfeeds.
- Customizable UI colors
- All news item data and optionally full articles and their images are stored locally on your device for offline reading.
- Synchronization of read news items across devices using WebDAV. While your devices are in your WLAN a little sync file is written to your webDav host and used across the devices
- Export and Import of OPML to get started with a setup from another reader
- Export and import of your settings. As the password is stored encrypted and the master key is device specific, you might export your settings on one device and import it on another, but you have to reenter the password afterward
- Identical App provided for Android and Desktop (currently Windows, Linux distro will be provided asap)
- Inbuilt Newsfeed catalog with german feeds from <https://www.rss-verzeichnis.de/> to get started easily

Installation

Downloads



On the package page just click on the latest version to download the desired files.

Build Yourself

To compile the executable on your local machine just check out the project somewhere, cd to the root directory and issue:

```
./gradlew zip assembleDebug
```

Directories

When the build finished successfully you find the final directory in directories

Windows Binary

```
<PROJECT_ROOT>/composeApp/build/compose/binaries/main/app/de.visualdigits.newshomereader
```

Copy the whole directory somewhere. The exe file is just a wrapper to a java main. Of course, you can rename the folder to whatever you like. You may then just double-click on the exe file, and you are good to go. Besides the exe you find this readme as a pdf file.

Windows zip file

```
<PROJECT_ROOT>/composeApp/build/distributions/NewsHomeReader_<VERSION>.zip
```

This contains the above directory as a zipped file.

Android apk

```
<PROJECT_ROOT>/composeApp/build/outputs/apk/debug/NewsHomeReader_debug.apk
```

This is an unsigned apk file which you can install on android devices. You have to allow installation from unknown locations. Also, you have to let scan the apk file on every install or update.

Preliminaries for building on your machine

- Temurin 21 JDK

- Wix Toolset
- Launch4j

Scoop

I highly recommend to make use of a JDK manager I use scoop for this.

To install scoop on your machine just open a PowerShell and issue:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope CurrentUser  
Invoke-RestMethod -Uri https://get.scoop.sh | Invoke-Expression
```

License

GNU GENERAL PUBLIC LICENSE v3 (2007)

This project is licensed under GPLv3. If you use this code in your app, your entire app must also be open-sourced under GPLv3.

What this means for you

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This project contains a Kotlin Multiplatform port of Essence, which remains under the Apache 2.0 license (see [Original Project License](#)).